

MB 404: Business Research Methods

Course Code	MB 404
Course Name	Business Research Methods
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	Problem Solving and Decision Making for Manager (MB 301)
Intended for	Integrated MBA
Mutual Exclusion	NA
Approval	59th BoA (Apr 2025), in the Integrated MBA (IMBA) curriculum; 65th BoA (Aug 2026)

Preamble

Business research is essential for evidence-based decision-making in today's dynamic and data-driven business environment. It enables organizations to identify problems, analyze data, and develop informed solutions that support strategic and operational objectives.

This course introduces the fundamental concepts and methods of business research, including problem formulation, literature review, research design, data collection, sampling, data management, and business data analysis. It also incorporates AI-enabled research practices such as AI-assisted literature reviews, prompt engineering, generative AI for research tasks, and the critical evaluation of AI-generated outputs.

Students will develop the skills to design and conduct research, analyze and interpret findings, and communicate actionable insights through professional reports, presentations, dashboards, and data storytelling. The course prepares learners to apply research and AI tools responsibly to solve real-world business problems and support effective managerial decision-making.

Course Modules

- **Business Research Fundamentals:** Nature and importance of business research, Scientific inquiry and evidence-based management- Business decision-making under uncertainty, Role of research in strategic decision-making, Research process, Types of business research, Research in digital and AI-enabled organizations, Business problems for analytics research. (5 hours)
- **Problem Formulation and Literature Review:** Identifying managerial problems, Converting business problems into research questions, Problem statements and Research objectives. Literature review techniques, AI-assisted literature review, Semantic search, Reference management, Prompt engineering for academic research. Academic and industry literature, Systematic literature review, Identifying research gaps, Developing hypotheses, Conceptual models, Variables and measurements. (8 hours)
- **Research Design and Data Collection:** Research designs: Experimental, Cross-sectional, Longitudinal, Case study, Survey research, and Action research. Data collection: Primary Data, Secondary Data. Questionnaire design, Measurement scales, Reliability and validity. (10 hours)
- **Sampling and Business Data Management:** Population and sampling frame, Sampling methods, Representativeness, Sample size determination, Sampling errors, Data quality and Business data governance. (6 hours)
- **Business Data Analysis:** Introduction to Descriptive Analytics, Inferential Analytics, Exploratory Analytics, Predictive Analytics. (5 hours)
- **AI for Business Research:** Generative AI for Business Research: Research planning, Literature summarization, Questionnaire generation, Coding qualitative responses. Evaluating AI-generated insights, Limitations of AI in research, Human oversight. (4 Hours)
- **Business Research Interpretation, Managerial Insight and Communication:** Research report structure, Executive summaries, Interpretation vs description, Managerial implications, Evidence-based business recommendations, Data storytelling, Strategic relevance, Research presentations, Communicating findings to management, Dashboard-based reporting. (4 Hours)

Laboratory Modules

None

Text Books

1. C. R. Kothari and Gaurav Garg. *Research Methodology: Methods and Techniques*.
2. John W. Creswell & J. David Creswell. *Research Design: Qualitative, Quantitative, and Mixed Methods Approaches*.

References

1. Uma Sekaran & Roger Bougie. *Research Methods for Business: A Skill-Building Approach*.
2. Mark Saunders, Philip Lewis & Adrian Thornhill. *Research Methods for Business Students*.
3. Thomas H. Davenport & Nitin Mittal. *All In on AI*.
4. Alan Bryman and Emma Bell, *Business Research Methods*, Oxford University Press, 2019.
5. Wayne C. Booth, Gregory G. Colomb, and Joseph M. Williams, *The Craft of Research*, University of Chicago Press, 2016.
6. Nick Lee and Ian Lings, *Doing Business Research*, 2008 (Sage Publications).
7. Provost, F and Fawcett, T., *Data Science for Business*, Shroff Publishers and Distributors Pvt. Ltd, 2014.